aimed at separating his party from Ben-Gvir's Jewish Power and showing that he and his party were acting responsibly. Ben-Gvir railed against the agreement; he and his ministers left notices "against" and did not wait for the end of the meeting. He knows that even in this government he is done once the war is over.

An illegal settlement that had been erected near Ofra was forcibly evacuated today by the army; the temporary constructions were dismantled. The settlers sent a virulent protest letter to the military commander of the West Bank. Thank God for this courageous initiative. The settlers' daily rampages against Palestinians are unbearable.

What can take the place of Hamas in postwar Gaza is the unresolved and essential issue. The most obvious answer is that some form of Palestinian authority should be in charge, but not one governed by the old and corrupt Mahmoud Abbas. Two potential candidates are regularly mentioned. Mohammed Dahlan was once the Fatah security chief in Gaza, until Hamas overthrew the Fatah leadership. He fled the Palestinian Authority territory in 2011 and lives in exile in Abu Dhabi. He is generally considered the rival of Mahmoud Abbas for leadership of a future Palestinian state and, needless to say, there is not much sympathy between Abbas and Dahlan. The other candidate, Marwan Barghouti, is in prison in Israel. Israel hasn't said that it agrees to either one of them, and in any case, Hamas is far from uprooted.

At about midnight in Israel, it was announced that the liberation of the hostages was being postponed until Friday, since the list of those to be freed has not yet been handed over and a formal agreement hasn't yet been signed. What the true reason for the postponement may be is not clear.

Thursday, November 23

The ceasefire starts tomorrow, Friday, at 7:00 a.m. local time, with a first group of thirteen hostages to be released at 4:00 p.m. Fifty hostages will be